

DINNER · POPPY'S KITCHEN

Taco Fiesta

Weeknight turkey tacos with real flavor: a hard sear, a saucy finish, and a build-your-own bar.

4, plus a lunch	25 min
SERVES	START TO TABLE
10 min	**15 min**
PREP	COOK

Easy weeknight

🛒 What you need

FROM THE STORE

- ☐ **1¼ lb** Ground turkey 94%
- ☐ **1 packet** Taco seasoning
- ☐ **¼ cup** Ortega taco sauce, plus more to serve
- ☐ **1 can** Bush's black beans, drained and rinsed
- ☐ **10** Mission soft taco tortillas
- ☐ **a few** Flour tortillas, for anyone who wants a burrito
- ☐ **1½ cups** Jack shreds
- ☐ **2** Limes

TACO BAR EXTRAS (WHATEVER WE HAVE)

- ☐ Shredded lettuce, sour cream, salsa, avocado, cilantro

FROM THE PANTRY

- ☐ **1 Tbsp** Olive oil
- ☐ **⅔ cup** Water

⚡ **First:** Oven on to 200°F for the tortillas.

GEAR

Big skillet · Foil · Small bowls for the taco bar

🔥 Let's cook

1. Set out the taco bar: cheese, lettuce, sour cream, salsa, limes cut in wedges. Warm the oven to 200°F for the tortillas. 🧒 Kids can do this
2. Heat the oil in a big skillet over medium-high until it shimmers. Add the turkey, press it flat, and leave it alone for 3–4 minutes so the bottom browns. ⏱️ 4 min
3. Break it into small crumbles and cook until no pink is left, about 3 minutes more. ⏱️ 3 min
4. Stir in the taco seasoning, the water and ¼ cup taco sauce. Simmer until it's saucy and glossy, not soupy. ⏱️ 4 min
5. Stir the black beans into the meat (or warm them in a small pot for anyone who wants them on the side). Squeeze in half a lime and taste. 🧒 Kids can do this
6. Wrap the tortillas in a damp paper towel, then foil, and warm them in the oven 10 minutes (or char each one 15 seconds over a gas flame). ⏱️ 10 min
7. Everyone builds their own. Leftover meat goes in a container for tomorrow's lunch before seconds start.



CHEF'S SECRET

Don't stir the turkey for the first 3–4 minutes. Lean turkey has little fat, so browning is where all the flavor comes from.

Poppy's draft. Change something? Tell Poppy with 💡 so the card learns.



DINNER · FLIP SIDE

Taco Fiesta

👩‍🍳 Kitchen crew: kid jobs

- [ ] Set up the taco bar in bowls and put a spoon in each one
- [ ] Cut the limes into wedges (with a grown-up)
- [ ] Drain and rinse the black beans in a strainer
- [ ] Count out tortillas and wrap them for the oven

Knives, the stove and the oven: a grown-up stays right there. Steps marked 🧒 **Kids can do this** on the front are theirs to own.

⏰ MAKE IT AHEAD

Cook the meat up to 2 days ahead; reheat with a splash of water.

🥡 LEFTOVERS

Taco bowls for lunch: meat + beans over Minute rice with cheese and salsa.

🔁 SWAP IT

- Ground beef works the same way
- Hard shells: bake 5 minutes at 375°F

🍽️ SERVE IT WITH

Tortilla chips and salsa, or Alexia street corn

📝 How'd it go tonight?

😍 Love it 🙂 Like it 😐 It's OK 👎 Not for me

Date _____ Cooked by _____

Helpers _____ Next time _____

Notes and tweaks (snap a photo and send it to Poppy with 💡)

Poppy's draft. Change something? Tell Poppy with 💡 so the card learns.